MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

QA Automation Engineer | DevOps / Platform Engineering
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including the last two focused primarily on CI/CD pipelines, test environments and build tooling. Owns CI pipelines and Kubernetes-based ephemeral test environments for three product teams. Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and helped lower flaky test rates from 7% to below 2%. Developing further hands-on infrastructure experience through a personal k3s and GitOps homelab, including Terraform-provisioned Hetzner infrastructure.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

CI/CD and containers: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose
Infrastructure and platforms: Kubernetes (namespace-level work on a shared cluster), Helm, k3s, Terraform (personal projects), Argo CD, Ansible (basic)
Monitoring and data: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL
Programming and scripting: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL
Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman
Cloud learning: AWS EC2 and S3 basics (personal learning)
Other: Linux, Git

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw | 2021-Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (approximately 25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests into their own stage.
- Built short-lived merge-request test environments with Docker Compose and later Helm on the company's shared Kubernetes cluster; write Helm charts and work with namespace-level access.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky test rate from 7% to below 2%.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling to seed test data into PostgreSQL.
- Wrote the internal guide to how CI works, which is used in onboarding; mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw | 2019-2021

- Tested web and mobile applications through manual and automated testing for client projects.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs for nightly regression runs.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House | 2018-2019

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, and reproduced bugs for developers.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal | 2024-2025

- Built a three-node k3s cluster on Raspberry Pi 5 devices; deployed applications from a Git repository using Argo CD.

- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki monitoring, Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health | 2023-2024

- Set up short-lived environments for each merge request, with the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data deployed via Helm to a shared Kubernetes cluster from GitLab CI.
- Configured automatic cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity; QA and product teams use the environments to review features, and end-to-end tests run against them.

CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health | 2022

- Profiled pipelines across three teams, parallelised test jobs, added dependency caching and split end-to-end tests into a separate stage.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner cost by approximately 30%.

Flaky Test Dashboard | Odrava Health | 2023

- Collected CI test results in PostgreSQL and built Grafana dashboards showing flaky tests by team.
- Flaky test rates fell from 7% to below 2% after teams began addressing the top offenders.

EDUCATION

BEng Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

CERTIFICATIONS AND DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA): studying; exam booked for January 2027

LANGUAGES

Polish (native), English (C1), German (A2)